

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Policy and Research Associate position at J-PAL Europe. The role strongly matches the direction I wish to give to my career: developing at the intersection of research, policy partnerships and impact evaluation, while contributing to the translation of rigorous evidence into actionable insights for policymakers and development actors.

My academic background has given me a strong foundation in economics, applied econometrics and quantitative policy analysis. During my Master's in Econometrics, International Economics and Development at Université Paris Dauphine - PSL, I studied applied econometrics, causal inference, microeconomics and development economics. These courses shaped my interest in evidence-based policymaking and in the use of rigorous empirical methods to understand which policies work, under what conditions and for whom.

My main research experience comes from my Master's thesis, initially developed around ecological transition, economic complexity and the emergence of green productive sectors. I am currently extending this work in my own time into a more operational agent-based modelling framework, as presented in my portfolio. This project has required me to formulate a research question, review relevant academic literature, structure large international datasets, build interpretable indicators and think carefully about how economic and environmental dynamics can be translated into policy-relevant scenarios. It reflects my interest in research that is methodologically grounded but ultimately useful for public decision-making.

I have also developed experience in evidence synthesis and policy-oriented writing. As part of a graded Master's project linked to an active Agence Française de Développement research programme, I produced a policy and research note on biodiversity-related transition risks. This work involved synthesising academic and institutional literature, identifying the implications of emerging research debates for development policy, and presenting the results in a structured format. I also produced policy-oriented work on the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism, the EU ETS and industrial competitiveness, translating a complex economic and regulatory issue into a concise argument for decision-makers.

My professional and voluntary experiences have strengthened the operational and communication skills required for this position. At Greenly, I worked as a Data Analyst and Climate Operations Intern, where I structured heterogeneous datasets, built indicators and dashboards, prepared analytical supports, and explained methods, assumptions and limitations to non-technical stakeholders. Through Data For Good, including a project with Reclaim Finance, I worked with data engineers and analysts to structure data pipelines, validate results, document analytical choices and produce outputs that could inform public-interest work. These experiences helped me develop the ability to manage several tasks, coordinate with different profiles and maintain attention to detail under time constraints.

I have not yet worked directly on the implementation of a randomised evaluation. However, I have studied causal inference and impact evaluation methods, and I am specifically motivated to deepen my practical understanding of randomised evaluations, research partnerships and evaluation design through J-PAL Europe. I am particularly interested in the way J-PAL works with policymakers, researchers and implementing partners to identify evaluation opportunities, clarify constraints and ensure that evidence can inform concrete decisions.

The position also appeals to me because of its policy outreach and training components. I would be motivated to contribute to policy briefs, research summaries, presentations, blogs, training materials and dissemination events aimed at making evidence accessible to policymakers and practitioners. I am comfortable writing and presenting in English and French, and I would value the opportunity to work in a multicultural research environment connected to J-PAL's global network, AFD, PSL and the Paris School of Economics.

Yours faithfully,

Yannis Daguenet